

LIBRARY RESEARCH SKILLS FOR FIRST YEAR SEMINAR STUDENTS



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Library Research Skills for First Year Seminar Students

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TABLE OF CONTENTS

Licensing

Acknowledgement

1: Introduction to the Library

- 1.1: Introduction to the Library

2: Finding Specific Books and Articles

- 2.1: Finding Specific Books and Articles
- 2.2: Finding a Book on the Shelf

3: Choosing a Research Topic and Key Terms

- 3.1: Choosing a Research Topic
- 3.2: Identifying Key Terms
- 3.3: Module 3 Exercise - Choosing a Research Topic and Key Terms

4: Searching for Information on a Topic

- 4.1: Why Search for Information?
- 4.2: Search Techniques
- 4.3: Where and How to Search
- 4.4: Types of Information Sources

5: Citing Your Sources

- 5.1: Introduction to Citation
- 5.2: What's Included in a Citation
- 5.3: Citation Resources
- 5.4: Module 4 and 5 Exercise - Finding and Citing Information on a Topic

Index

Glossary

Detailed Licensing

Detailed Licensing

Licensing

A detailed breakdown of this resource's licensing can be found in [Back Matter/Detailed Licensing](#).

Acknowledgement

2

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

1: Introduction to the Library

1.1: Introduction to the Library

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1.1: Introduction to the Library

We're here to help!

My name is Kara Blizzard, and I'm a librarian at Augustana. My colleagues and I are here to help you with your research throughout your time at Augustana. If you have any questions about your research or about library services, you are very welcome to:

- [Ask us](#) by email or chat
- Visit the [Augustana Library](#) service desk in person
- [Email me directly](#)

We offer many services and resources

Augustana graduate Braeden will take you on a tour of the library.

Next we will explore [how to find specific books and articles](#).

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

2: Finding Specific Books and Articles

[2.1: Finding Specific Books and Articles](#)

[2.2: Finding a Book on the Shelf](#)

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2.1: Finding Specific Books and Articles

You'll need to find readings for many of your courses at Augustana, including FYS. The search box on the library website is the place to search for books, articles, and other items in our collection. Click through the interactive slides below to learn how it works.

Check Your Understanding

Next you'll learn [how to find a book within the library building](#).

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2.2: Finding a Book on the Shelf

To find a book in the library, you'll need to know how to read its call number. Watch the video below to learn how. You can also use [the How to Read a Call Number document](#), which gives a summary of how call numbers are organized.

One or more interactive elements has been excluded from this version of the text. You can view them online here: <https://pressbooks.openeducationalberta.ca/auglibfys/?p=46#oembed-1>

Check Your Understanding

Now we'll explore [how to choose a research topic](#).

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

3: Choosing a Research Topic and Key Terms

[3.1: Choosing a Research Topic](#)

[3.2: Identifying Key Terms](#)

[3.3: Module 3 Exercise - Choosing a Research Topic and Key Terms](#)

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3.1: Choosing a Research Topic

Note about Module 3 Exercise

At the end of Module 3, you will be asked to complete [an exercise involving choosing a research topic and identifying its key terms](#). If you learn best by doing, you can already download that exercise and work on it as you complete Module 3.

Choosing a topic is a crucial part of the research process. The video below explains some of the things you should consider when deciding on a topic.

One or more interactive elements has been excluded from this version of the text. You can view them online here: <https://pressbooks.openeducationalberta.ca/auglibfys/?p=48#oembed-1>

Check Your Understanding

Now you'll learn [how to identify the key terms in your topic](#).

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3.2: Identifying Key Terms

Once you have a topic in mind, identifying its key terms can help direct your research. The next video explains how to do this.

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Check Your Understanding

The next step is to complete the [Module 3 Exercise](#).

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3.3: Module 3 Exercise - Choosing a Research Topic and Key Terms

Now that you have learned about choosing a research topic and identifying its key terms, you're ready to complete the Module 3 Exercise, which asks you to identify your own research topic and its key terms.

When you click on the following Google Doc link, it will prompt you to make a copy. Then you can edit your copy and print it or upload it to eClass (or Canvas) to submit to your course instructor. Check with your instructor if you are unsure whether or how to submit it.

Module 3 Exercise: Choosing a Research Topic and Key Terms (Google Doc)

Next we'll explore [why it's important to search for information](#).

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

4: Searching for Information on a Topic

[4.1: Why Search for Information?](#)

[4.2: Search Techniques](#)

[4.3: Where and How to Search](#)

[4.4: Types of Information Sources](#)

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4.1: Why Search for Information?

Note about Module 4 & 5 Exercise

At the end of Module 5, you will be asked to complete [an exercise involving finding information on a topic and then citing it](#). If you learn best by doing, you can already download that exercise and work on it as you complete Modules 4 and 5.

Your university professors will often ask you to find and use information sources when you write about a topic. Why do you need to incorporate other people's ideas? Click on each of the reasons below to learn about them.

Later you'll learn about how to cite the sources you use, but next we're going to look at [how to find them](#).

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4.2: Search Techniques

Putting a Search Together

Before you start to search for information, it's a good idea to know some strategies for putting a search together. The next video shows how to combine your key terms.

One or more interactive elements has been excluded from this version of the text. You can view them online here: <https://pressbooks.openeducationalberta.ca/auglibfys/?p=55#oembed-1>

Check Your Understanding

Truncation and Phrase Searching

There are two more techniques that can come in handy when you're searching library databases: truncation and phrase searching. Watch the video below to learn how they work.

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Check Your Understanding

Next you'll learn [where and how you can search for information](#).

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4.3: Where and How to Search

Now that you've learned how to combine your search terms and use truncation and phrase searching, you're ready to search for books and articles on your topic. The interactive slides below show how to get started.

Check your knowledge

Next we'll look at [different types of information sources](#).

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4.4: Types of Information Sources

Identifying Information Sources

When you're doing any kind of research, you are likely to encounter many different types of information sources. Usually, your instructor will ask you to find scholarly or academic sources, which are written by experts with the goal of advancing knowledge in their field.

The following interactive slides list some common information sources and their characteristics. Click on the information icons



for tips and examples.

Check Your Understanding

The Peer Review Process

Your course instructor might ask you to find peer-reviewed or scholarly articles on a topic. But what does peer review actually mean? The next video explains.

One or more interactive elements has been excluded from this version of the text. You can view them online here: <https://pressbooks.openeducationalberta.ca/auglibfys/?p=59#oembed-1>

When you use the main library search box, you can limit your results to “Scholarly (Peer Reviewed) Journals” in the “Refine Results” menu so that you only find peer-reviewed articles.

Resource Type ▼

- ☐ All Results
- ☒ Academic Journals (12)
- ☐ Research Starters (10)
- ☐ Electronic Resources (6)
- ☐ eBooks (5)
- ☐ Magazines (3)

Check Your Understanding

In the next module, you'll learn about [citing your sources](#).

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CHAPTER OVERVIEW

5: Citing Your Sources

[5.1: Introduction to Citation](#)

[5.2: What's Included in a Citation](#)

[5.3: Citation Resources](#)

[5.4: Module 4 and 5 Exercise - Finding and Citing Information on a Topic](#)

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5.1: Introduction to Citation

Why Cite?

What is citation, and why is it important? Watch the video below to find out.

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Check Your Understanding

Next we will explore [what should be included in a citation](#).

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5.2: What's Included in a Citation

There are thousands of citation styles, and they all have different guidelines for how to format citations. However, most of them include the same types of information about a source.

In-text Citation

An in-text citation goes in your paper at the point where you quote, paraphrase, or summarize an idea from an information source. The elements and formatting will vary depending on the style you are using.

For example, an **MLA-style** in-text citation includes the **author name(s) and the page number** of the information:

(Bruce and Lamb 68)

An **APA-style** in-text citation includes the **author name(s) and the year of publication**:

(Bruce & Lamb, 2019)

Some **other citation styles**, such as Chicago's notes-bibliography system and ACS style, use **footnotes or endnotes** to indicate citations.

Works Cited (or Reference) List Entry

A reference list, or works cited list, includes all of the publication details about each source cited in your paper, so readers can identify and find the sources you have used. The elements included in a reference and how they are formatted will vary depending on the style. Still, a reference in any style answers four questions about an information source. Read through the following interactive slides to learn more.

Check Your Understanding

Use the screenshot below, or the [example journal article \(PDF\)](#), to answer the questions that follow.

Review of Economic Analysis 12 (2020) 403-438

1973-3909/2020403

Spend Less, Get More? Explaining Health Spending and Outcome Differences Between Canada and Italy

LIVIO DI MATTEO*

Lakehead University

THOMAS BARBIERO

Ryerson University

[Example article](#) is licensed under [CC-BY-NC 4.0](#).

Now you'll learn about the [citation resources available to you](#).

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5.3: Citation Resources

The U of A Library's [Citation Guides](#) provide resources for citing information sources in several different styles. The following tutorials and guides can help you get started. If you are unsure which citation style to use, ask your course instructor.

MLA

- [MLA Style Citation Tutorial](#)
- [More MLA style resources](#)

APA

- [APA Style Citation Tutorial](#)
- [More APA style resources](#)

Chicago

- [Chicago style resources](#)

CSE

- [CSE style resources](#)

ACS

- [ACS style resources](#)

If you have questions, you are welcome to [ask us](#). While library staff cannot check your citations for correctness, we can give you some guidance and show you relevant examples.

Next you'll complete the [Module 4 & 5 exercise on finding information and citing your sources](#).

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5.4: Module 4 and 5 Exercise - Finding and Citing Information on a Topic

Now that you have learned about searching for books and articles and citing them, you're ready to complete the Module 4 & 5 Exercise, which asks you to find one book and one article relevant to your topic and cite them.

When you click on the link below, it will prompt you to make a copy. Then you can edit your copy and print it or upload it to eClass (or Canvas) to submit to your course instructor. Check with your instructor if you are unsure whether or how to submit it.

[Module 4 & 5 Exercise: Finding and Citing Information on a Topic \(Google Doc\)](#)

Now it's time to [finish the modules!](#)

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Index

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Detailed Licensing

Overview

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 - [TitlePage](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [InfoPage](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Table of Contents](#) - [Undeclared](#)
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 - [Acknowledgement](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1: Introduction to the Library](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.1: Introduction to the Library](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2: Finding Specific Books and Articles](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.1: Finding Specific Books and Articles](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.2: Finding a Book on the Shelf](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3: Choosing a Research Topic and Key Terms](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.1: Choosing a Research Topic](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.2: Identifying Key Terms](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.3: Module 3 Exercise - Choosing a Research Topic and Key Terms](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [4: Searching for Information on a Topic](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [4.1: Why Search for Information?](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [4.2: Search Techniques](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [4.3: Where and How to Search](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [4.4: Types of Information Sources](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [5: Citing Your Sources](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [5.1: Introduction to Citation](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [5.2: What's Included in a Citation](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [5.3: Citation Resources](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [5.4: Module 4 and 5 Exercise - Finding and Citing Information on a Topic](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Back Matter](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Index](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Glossary](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Detailed Licensing](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Detailed Licensing](#) - [Undeclared](#)

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Overview

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 - [Front Matter](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [TitlePage](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [InfoPage](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Table of Contents](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Licensing](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Acknowledgement](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1: Introduction to the Library](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [1.1: Introduction to the Library](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2: Finding Specific Books and Articles](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.1: Finding Specific Books and Articles](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [2.2: Finding a Book on the Shelf](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3: Choosing a Research Topic and Key Terms](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.1: Choosing a Research Topic](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.2: Identifying Key Terms](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [3.3: Module 3 Exercise - Choosing a Research Topic and Key Terms](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [4: Searching for Information on a Topic](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [4.1: Why Search for Information?](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [4.2: Search Techniques](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [4.3: Where and How to Search](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [4.4: Types of Information Sources](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [5: Citing Your Sources](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [5.1: Introduction to Citation](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [5.2: What's Included in a Citation](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [5.3: Citation Resources](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [5.4: Module 4 and 5 Exercise - Finding and Citing Information on a Topic](#) - [CC BY-NC-SA 4.0](#)
 - [Back Matter](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Index](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Glossary](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Detailed Licensing](#) - [Undeclared](#)
 - [Detailed Licensing](#) - [Undeclared](#)